TAMARA STONE, EXP REALTY

Lake Oswego Home Buyer's Guide

FIND YOUR HOME ON THE LAKE.

Everything you need to buy a home in Lake Oswego — where to look, what lake life is really like, and how to get from first tour to front door.

LAKE OSWEGO MARKET — OCT 2026: $1,014,517 MEDIAN SALE PRICE, 29 DAYS ON MARKET (REDFIN). PUBLIC LAKE ACCESS OPEN AT MILLENNIUM PLAZA PARK.

Tamara Stone at Oswego Lake in Lake Oswego, Oregon



The Lake Oswego Ledger

405 acres of Oswego Lake
About 3 miles long, ringed by the town

40,731 residents
2020 census figure

7 miles to downtown Portland
South along the Willamette

1910, incorporated as Oswego
Renamed Lake Oswego in 1960

$1,014,517
median sale price (Redfin, Oct 2026)

29
days on market (Redfin, Oct 2026)

01 · THE STORY

Lake town, small-town pulse.

Downtown runs a few walkable blocks. People know each other here — generations of them — and the water is the center of gravity. Buyers tell me the same thing over and over: it feels settled and a little charmed.

In 2025, public access to the lake opened at Lower Millennium Plaza Park, after the city chose not to fight the court ruling. Anyone can now get on the water from the park steps.



On the trail — fall in Lake Oswego

02 · NEIGHBORHOODS

Every corner of the lake town.

Old Town

Older homes and cottages on walkable streets near downtown and the lakefront.

Lake Grove

West-side streets near shopping, parks, and the lake, with mid-century homes and newer builds.

Palisades

Quieter, established streets with larger lots, some with lake access.



Westlake Rd in Lake Oswego

25 neighborhoods

Lake Oswego has 25 city-recognized neighborhoods. These are ten buyers ask about most — ask me about the other 15, and which one fits you.

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Westlake

Planned west-side streets around a private lake, parks, and paths.

Mountain Park

Planned community on Mount Sylvania, with an HOA recreation center, pools, and miles of trails.

Lakewood

A peninsula into Oswego Lake, bordered by Lakewood Bay. Some homes have private docks.

First Addition / Forest Hills

The town's oldest streets, a walkable grid near downtown.

Evergreen

Near Lakewood Bay; some homes carry a deeded lake easement. Rossman Park is nearby.

Glenmorrie

A wooded enclave south of downtown, laid out on a 600-acre country estate on the Willamette's west bank. Glenmorrie Park and Old River Road trails run through it.

Blue Heron

Lakefront streets bordered by two canals feeding Oswego Lake; nearly a third of lots sit on the canals. Older ranch homes mix with newer two-story builds on wide, sidewalk-lined streets.

Neighborhood associations per the City of Lake Oswego Neighborhood Association Program.

NEIGHBORHOODS

What recent medians say, by area.

Recent medians, grouped into two broad bands. A band is a starting point for a search, not a price for any one house.

Bands for the ten neighborhoods listed in this guide.

Citywide, the October 2026 Lake Oswego median was $1,014,517 (Redfin). Most area medians sit on either side of it.

Under $1,000,000

Mountain Park

$1,000,000 to $2,000,000

Blue Heron, Evergreen, First Addition / Forest Hills, Glenmorrie, Lake Grove, Lakewood, Palisades, Westlake

No band shown for Old Town. Published medians there were too thin, or disagreed across a band line, to band honestly.

Bands group published neighborhood median sale and listing prices (Realtor.com median listing prices, September 2026, and Homes.com median sale prices, 2026). Medians cover all home types and move with small sale counts. A single home can sit far from its area median. Market data only. Check current sales for the street, not just the area.

LAKE DAYS

The lake isn't scenery. It's the lifestyle.

Summer weekends mean paddleboards at sunrise, kayaks crossing the water, and boats out for the July 4th fireworks. Winter is quieter: fireplaces, neighborhood dinners, the lake glassy under the fog.

The lake is the lifestyle — but access isn't the same for every house. Anyone can get on the water from the public steps at Lower Millennium Plaza Park, and that's real. Easy, private access still comes with the property, so it's something we check house by house.



Evening on the lake

COMMUNITY LIFE

Always something on.

Lake Oswego does not hibernate. From summer concerts on the grass to December trolley rides, there is something on the calendar in every season.

- Wednesday Concert Series — free summer concerts, July at Foothills Park and August at Westlake Park.
- Farmers Market — Saturdays, 8:30 AM to 1:30 PM, mid-May through October, Millennium Plaza Park.
- Fourth of July — Star Spangled Parade down A Avenue, a celebration at Millennium Plaza Park, and fireworks over the lake at dusk.
- Movies in the Park — summer outdoor movies at Millennium Plaza Park.
- Festival of the Arts — a three-day June weekend at the Lakewood Center, with art, food, and music.
- Holiday season — Tree Lighting Festival the day after Thanksgiving, Tinseltown Trolley rides in December, and the Christmas Ships Parade viewed from Foothills Park.
- Willamette Shore Trolley — weekend rides Memorial Day through late September, from the Lake Oswego depot to Portland's South Waterfront.
- Gallery Without Walls — a year-round outdoor sculpture exhibit downtown, free to walk.



Summer Concert Series at Foothills Park.

Every season has its own calendar — ask me what is on this week.

BUYING COSTS

What it actually costs to buy here.

An example at the October 2026 Lake Oswego median of $1,014,517 (Redfin). Your numbers will differ — this is the shape of it, not a quote.

Down payment examples at $1,014,517

3% down — $30,436 down, $984,081 loan
5% down — $50,726 down, $963,791 loan
10% down — $101,452 down, $913,065 loan
20% down — $202,903 down, $811,614 loan

20% down usually avoids private mortgage insurance.

Closing costs are separate from the down payment. They typically run 2% to 5% of the loan amount and cover lender origination, appraisal, title search and title insurance, escrow and settlement, recording fees, prepaid interest, prepaid property taxes and homeowner's insurance, and initial escrow funding. On the 20%-down loan above ($811,614), that is roughly $16,200 to $40,600.

Oregon's property tax quirk: you are taxed on the lower of a home's real market value and its maximum assessed value. The maximum assessed value generally rises no more than 3% a year, and it does not reset to the sale price when a home changes hands. A home owned for many years can therefore carry an assessed value well below its market value — and that gap carries to the new owner. Your tax statement shows both values.

If you are an eligible veteran, a VA loan may allow no down payment, and some VA loans can be assumed by a qualified buyer, subject to lender and servicer approval. Availability depends on the specific loan.

Example only. Your down payment, closing costs, and monthly payment vary by loan, lender, property, and timing. Your lender's Loan Estimate is the real number.

Ready to talk it through?

Grab a time on my calendar: book.specialagenttam.com

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HOUSE-BY-HOUSE CHECKLIST

Take this to showings.

Get each answer in writing — deeds, maps, and reports, not assurances.

[ ] Lake access — What kind of lake access comes with this house: deeded, easement, or HOA? Is it written in the deed?

[ ] Lakefront vs. lake access — Lakefront, lake view, or lake access: which one is it, exactly?

[ ] Sewer or septic — City sewer or septic? If septic, when was it last inspected?

[ ] Flood zone — Is any part of the lot in a flood zone? Check the map for this address.

[ ] Easements — What easements cross the lot: utility, access, or lake?

[ ] Water source — City water or a well?

[ ] Drainage — How does water drain off the lot? Any history of standing water?

[ ] Roof and systems — How old are the roof, furnace, and water heater?

[ ] HOA — HOA dues, and what do they actually cover?

[ ] Permits — Were additions and remodels permitted? Ask for the record.

[ ] Sewer scope — Has the sewer line been scoped?

Not legal or tax advice — confirm with your inspector, lender, and title company.

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BEFORE YOU OFFER

Surprises to check before you offer.

Four checks that save buyers from unhappy surprises. None of these is a reason to walk away on its own. Each one is a question to answer in writing before you offer.

Lake access is not one thing

Deeded access, an easement, and HOA rights are different rights, and they are not interchangeable. Anyone can now use the public steps at Lower Millennium Plaza Park (City action, 2025), but private access still comes with the property, house by house. Get the exact right in the deed, not in a listing line.

The sewer scope

A scope can reveal a line that needs repair or replacement, which nothing inside the house shows. Ask whether the line has been scoped, and get the report, not just the answer.

Unpermitted work

Additions and remodels done without permits can stall a lender, an insurer, or a future sale. Ask for the permit record for any addition or remodel, and confirm it matches what you see.

Flood insurance

A lot can sit partly in a flood zone even when the house looks high and dry. Check the flood map for the exact address, and ask your lender and insurer what coverage that map means for this house.

Not legal or tax advice. Confirm with your inspector, lender, and title company.



Back to school — autumn

03 · SCHOOLS & AMENITIES

An A+ district in a town of parks.

The Lake Oswego School District serves about 6,800 students across seven elementary schools, two middle schools, and two high schools. Add a riverfront park scene, a downtown plaza, and miles of trails, and the calendar fills itself.

Niche 2027: **A+ Overall Niche Grade**

Niche 2027: **#1 of 144 in Best School Districts in Oregon**

6,800 students

K to 12

Source: https://www.niche.com/k12/d/lake-oswego-school-district-or/

SCHOOLS, CONTINUED

How to check the school for an address.

An address, not a neighborhood name, decides the resident school. Here is how to confirm it before you buy.

1. Use the district tool.

On the Lake Oswego School District site, open the LOSD Boundary Search Tool and enter the exact home address. It shows the resident school for that address.

2. Or call the district.

The District office can confirm the resident school for an exact address: 503-534-2000.

3. Register at the resident school first.

A student's resident school is set by home address. Families register at the resident school before applying for any transfer.

School assignments change. Confirm with the Lake Oswego School District before you buy.

WORTH ASKING

When you check an address, ask the district:

1. Does the assignment stay the same from elementary through high school, or does it change by level?
2. Has this boundary moved in the last few years?
3. What happens if you are buying mid-year — can you enroll right away?

Have an address in mind? Book a call and we will check it together: **book.specialagenttam.com**

04 · THE PATH TO KEYS

Four moves to the keys.

01

Get your financing in order

A pre-approval tells you the number — and in this market, it tells sellers you’re real.

02

Pick your neighborhood

Walkable Old Town or wooded Westlake, lake views or a quiet cul-de-sac. We’ll map the options together.

03

Tour with a local

I know the streets, the setbacks, and the difference between a view and a water view.

04

Offer, inspect, close

A clear offer, a sharp inspector, and a closing that lands you the keys.

The full guide covers the market, offer strategy, inspections, and what to know before you write an offer — ask me for it.

ABOUT

Hi, I'm Tam.

I’m Tamara Stone, a real estate agent with eXp Realty, and I live in Mountain Park right here in Lake Oswego. I help buyers find their place in this town — not just a house, but the neighborhood, the lake life, and the community that fits them.

THE PATH TO KEYS, CONTINUED

From accepted offer to keys.

Typical sequence, typical ranges. Every deal varies. Lender, loan type, and what the checks turn up all move the dates.

1. Offer accepted.

The clock starts when both sides sign. Negotiation itself usually takes hours to a few days.

2. Inspection.

Usually scheduled in the first 7 to 10 days after acceptance. The report can lead to repair talks or credits.

3. Appraisal.

The lender orders it early. It typically comes back in 1 to 2 weeks. A low appraisal can reopen negotiation.

4. Title.

The title search and title insurance typically take 1 to 2 weeks and run alongside the loan work.

5. Underwriting and disclosure.

Underwriting typically takes 2 to 4 weeks. The Closing Disclosure must reach you at least 3 business days before signing.

6. Walkthrough and signing.

A final walkthrough typically happens 24 to 48 hours before close. On signing day, funds move, the deed records, and you get the keys.

With financing, a typical window from accepted offer to keys is 30 to 45 days. Cash purchases can close faster. These are typical ranges, not promises. Your lender’s dates govern.



Tamara Stone's Mountain Park for-sale sign

RECENT PROOF

A recent listing went pending in 6 days after multiple offers, with clean terms and a strong price. It was priced right from the start — and in this market, the price is the strategy.



Tamara Stone

Your Move, My Mission. ♥

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05 · THE FIRST STEP

Where are you in the process?

Whether you’re pre-approved, pre-curious, or just starting to scroll listings, a short conversation with a local buyer’s agent makes everything clearer. No pressure, no jargon, no obligation.



Tamara Stone

- A straight answer on what Lake Oswego homes really cost, block by block.
- Neighborhood tours that match how you actually live, not just your budget.
- An offer plan built from current market data, not last year’s gut feel.

Thanks for reading this far — now let's find your place here.
I live right here in Mountain Park, your friendly neighborhood realtor. Around here they call me the Queen of Mt. Park — I say it with a smile, and I mean the part about knowing these streets. ♥

Prefer to just book? Grab a time on my calendar: book.specialagenttam.com

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This guide is general information, not legal, tax, or financial advice. Market statistics from Redfin, October 2026, and change over time. School assignments change — confirm with the Lake Oswego School District before you buy.

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